

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
1	RFI 2 Letter	<i>General</i>	Draft RFP	Is a Draft RFP planned for the SPARTAN MAC IDIQ? If so, when is the expected release date of the Draft RFP?	The Government has not made any final decisions on whether draft RFP will be executed.
2	RFI 2 Letter	<i>General</i>	RFP Release	When is the expected release date of the Final RFP for the SPARTAN MAC IDIQ?	Any expected timelines (to include RFP, award, etc.) can not be determined at this time.
3	RFI 2 Letter	<i>General</i>	Number of Awards	How many Prime awards are expected for the SPARTAN MAC IDIQ?	The Government will inform potential offerors at a later date.
4	RFI 2 Letter	<i>General</i>	Task Orders	Will Task Order(s) (TOs) be awardable upon award of the SPARTAN MAC IDIQ?	Yes.
5	SOO		Capability Area	Which of the 10 Capability Areas (CAs) outlined in the Statement of Objectives (SOO) are expected to be addressed in the initial Task Orders?	CAs will be addressed as determined by priority of IDCS execution (TBD).
6	SOO	2	Capability Area	Are there any CAs that are considered higher priority for immediate implementation?	IDCS PMO is considering options for Oral presentations currently for both the overarching IDIQ, and at the Task Order level.
7	SOO	2	Capability Area	Will Task Orders focus on single CAs or multiple, integrated CAs?	One (1) given CA will drive specificity to a Task Order, however, the co-mingling of CAs to execute a given Task Order is likely, i.e. CA1 (cloud) and CA6 (compliance) in a single award to ensure objectives are met.
8	SOO		TO Awards	When is the expected award and start date for initial Task Orders on the SPARTAN MAC IDIQ?	The Government will inform potential offerors at a later date.

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9	RFI 2 Letter	<i>General</i>	Oral Presentations	To streamline the solicitation process and provide a means for the Government to directly validate offeror competency, will the Government be including Oral presentations as part of the solicitation and evaluation process?	At this present time the Government is evaluating all forms of responses to include: oral/briefing, video presentation, or written. Offerors will identified at the discretion of the Government if further clarification is needed and that method.
10	LCAT Table	<i>General</i>	LCAT	The following Labor Categories (LCATs) are listed as Key Personnel Positions (KPP) in Attachment 2 SPARTAN LCATS Table: Threat Intelligence Analyst, Cybersecurity Research Scientist, Vulnerability Researcher, and Red Team Operator. Will the Government be revising KPP based on LCATs associated to particular CA(s) where such CA(s) are associated to particular Task Order(s)?	Yes, the provided LCAT table is merely a overarching notional inventory for the entire SPARTAN IDIQ. We are seeking inputs on revisions/additions to the table to ensure ~99.9999 coverage of LCATs that will be required for the entirety of the contract. KPPs and LCATs will be determined by Task Order requirements.
11	SOO	<i>Para 4.5, 4.5.3 – 4.5.10</i>	Capability Area	For CA 1 and CA 2, General, Task Description, and Performance Standards are provided, but for CA 3 through CA 10, only General and Task Descriptions are provided. Are there Performance Standards or will Performance Standards be provided for CA 3 through CA 10?	Performance standards will be provided for all capabilities.

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12	RFI 2 Letter	<i>General</i>	RFP Release	Does the Government plan to release a draft RFP, to include an updated SOO and draft Section L&M criteria, based on this RFI feedback, or just release an updated SOO?	IDCS PMO is considering options for Oral presentations currently for both the overarching IDIQ, and at the TO level.
13	SOO	<i>All</i>	Mention of SPARTAN vs IDCS	The document seems to oscillate between "IDCS" and "SPARTAN" names, inferring these terms are interchangeable. It seems that sometimes "SPARTAN" is meant when saying "IDCS". Is it possible to clarify the Government's specific difference between IDCS and SPARTAN?	SPARTAN is the name of the contract vehicle; IDCS is the System-of-Systems
14	SOO	<i>2. Scope</i>	Scope (IOP)	Document states: "Interoperability Platforms (IOPs) will be sustained until their tasks are fully absorbed by IDCS." Will the new contract performer be responsible for all sustainment for all previous and new weapon systems platforms?	See Amend. 1, Attachment 1, SPARTAN SOO_Rev 16 Sept 2025, Section 2. Scope, IOP should have been defined as Information Operations Platform. No. The performer will be responsible to specific Task Orders associated with their respective award/s and requirements.

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15	SOO	<i>2. Scope</i>	Scope (IOP)	Document states: "Interoperability Platforms (IOPs) will be sustained until their tasks are fully absorbed by IDCS." Is the IOP sustainment expected to be performed by the incoming contractor?	See Amend. 1, Attachment 1, SPARTAN SOO_Rev 16 Sept 2025, Section 2. Scope, IOP should have been defined as Information Operations Platform. All IDCS efforts and technical requirements are currently being assessed to identify which programs, and sustainment efforts are best suited for inclusion in the SPARTAN MAC IDIQ vehicle. Therefore, if IOP transitions to the SPARTAN vehicle, yes, IOP will potentially transition to the most suitable vendor.
16	SOO	<i>2. Scope</i>	Scope (IOP)	Document states: "Interoperability Platforms (IOPs) will be sustained until their tasks are fully absorbed by IDCS." Does IOP sustainment include VOLTRN+?	See Amend. 1, Attachment 1, SPARTAN SOO_Rev 16 Sept 2025, Section 2. Scope, IOP should have been defined as Information Operations Platform. No.
17	SOO	<i>2. Scope</i>	Scope (IOP)	Document states: "Interoperability Platforms (IOPs) will be sustained until their tasks are fully absorbed by IDCS." Are there other IOPs to be sustained by the performer?	See Amend. 1, Attachment 1, SPARTAN SOO_Rev 16 Sept 2025, Section 2. Scope, IOP should have been defined as Information Operations Platform. There is only one IOP program and capability with in the PMO.

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18	SOO	<i>4.5.6.1</i>	C5I Support	The Government states, "The IDCS aligns three (3) defensive cyberspace weapon systems into a single, configurable platform that enables operators to sense, make sense, and act with speed, precision, and common data." Will the Government provide a detailed overview description of each weapon system (CVA/H, ACD, and CDA) supported under this contract?	More details will be provided as part of the RFP with the addition of a potential CUI level reading room. It will require DoD CAC/ECA and DoD email to access it. Instructions will be provided as part of the RFP package. Detailed requirements will be provided for Task Orders with any applicable/ supporting core documentation.
19	SOO	<i>All</i>	No diagrams	Is the Government amenable to sharing OV-1s and architecture diagrams of the current IDCS implementation?	More details will be provided as part of the RFP with the addition of a potential CUI level reading room. It will require DoD CAC/ECA and DoD email to access it. Instructions will be provided as part of the RFP package. Detailed requirements will be provided for Task Orders with any applicable/ supporting core documentation.
20	SOO	<i>4.5.6.2</i>	Contractor shall develop, assist with integration, and sustain C2 applications.	This description seems to go beyond the SPARTAN platform into the development of C4I Mission Applications. Is the Government asking the provider to develop and help develop C4I Mission Application software that would ride on SPARTAN?	SPARTAN is the name of the contract vehicle; IDCS is the System-of-Systems. Currently, in most cases the integration of Kubernetes containers (.yaml, etc.) and analytics will constitute the extent of development to be performed by the developer. It is anticipated that future requirements require development of custom C2 applications.

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21	SOO	5.4	Travel	The Government states, "The Contractor may be required to travel to various locations within the Continental United States (CONUS) and Outside the Continental United States (OCONUS) in performance of this contract. Will the Government provide a separate travel CLIN with a ceiling to ensure all offerors provide the same value?	The Government has not made a determination on CLIN structure but will inform potential vendors at a later date.
22	SOO	Appendix A, 4.	IDCS Capability Areas & Objectives Matrix	"ELX" is mentioned once. Will the Government please define this acronym?	See Amend. 1, Attachment 1, SPARTAN SOO_Rev 16 Sept 2025, Appendix A, Section 4.1 has been updated to spell out ELX and BDP.
23	SOO	Appendix A, 5.	IDCS Capability Areas & Objectives Matrix	The Government identifies, "Support integration efforts with solutions from multiple vendors, ensuring a cohesive and unified IDCS SoS." Can the Government identify if the 10 CA areas will be performed by multiple contractors via separate task orders?	The 10 CA areas are overarching to the entire IDCS SoS. Therefore, as an example, there will be multiple Task Orders competed under any given CA of the 10 CAs. Providing multiple opportunities for vendors to compete and/or team for these CA Task Orders to increase business opportunities within industry.
24	SOO	All	No diagrams	Is the Government amenable to sharing OV-1s and architecture diagrams of the current implementation?	OV-1s and other architectures will be identified within the SPARTAN RFP and /or a potential industry day or similar activity (if the Government elects to conduct these activities)

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25	RFI 2 Letter	3.4.1	The Government provides a list of support vendors, but not a list of current performers and contracts being performed.	Will the Government provide a list of current performers (not support vendors) and contract numbers at assist industry in collaborating with industry partners for forming the best aligned team?	No
26	RFI 2 Letter	4	Industry Discussions	Will the Government consider hosting a classified meeting with interested parties to discuss operational requirements?	No
27	RFI 2 Letter	N/A	SCIF	How many seats are available for the contractor within the Government-provided SCIF?	Classified facility seats may be required. It is highly encourage for vendors to have their own classified facility access, or consider vendor teaming to increase meeting IDCS classified facility requirements. The security requirements for secure facilities are currently being considered by the IDCS PMO.
28	RFI 2 Letter	N/A	SCIF	Will the Government be willing to sponsor a contractor-provided SCIF to support operational requirements?	No - Not at this time.
29	LCAT Table	General	FTE	Will the Government provide an initial estimate for a baseline FTE count to support the initial tasks?	No, not at this time.
30	SOO	2	Scope (IOP)	Document states: "Interoperability Platforms (IOPs) will be sustained until their tasks are fully absorbed by IDCS." Will the Government please define the available Interoperability Platforms?	See Amend. 1, Attachment 1, SPARTAN SOO_Rev 16 Sept 2025, Section 2. Scope, IOP should have been defined as Information Operations Platform. The IOP is a legacy DoD USAF GOTs IDPS Sensor platform. These systems are limited in quantity.

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31	RFI 2 Letter	2.5	Contract that interface with the SPARTAN IDIQ	Will the Government confirm if there are other programs or contracts that interface with SPARTAN IDCS? If so, please provide relevant, appropriate technical details for interface requirements.	The Government can not identify this at this time.
32	RFI 2 Letter	2.5	Integration	Please confirm if there are specific integration requirements with other Air Force or DoD systems we should consider in our technical approach.	Yes, IDCS, and legacy systems by design integrate into AFIN and AFNET as they are the Defense Cyber Systems for the USAF.
33	RFI 2 Letter	2.1	Cloud Solution Provider	Please confirm who is holds the relationship and contracts with CSPs (AWS, Azure, etc.) - the Government or the contractor.	The Government holds the contracts with CSPs
34	RFI 2 Letter	2.11.2	Surge	What historical surge requirements have you experienced, and what response timeframes are expected for surge staffing?	Not providing at this time. Surge requirements potentially will be determined by each specific Task Order. There will be further direction in the RFP pertaining to surge.
35	RFI 2 Letter	2.9	Performance Measures	Will the Government provide current performance baselines for key metrics such as system availability, incident response times, and deployment frequency?	This will be identified at the Task Order level.

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36	SOO	5.1	Remote work and clearance levels	Please provide the percentage of the work must be performed on-site in San Antonio versus remotely? Are there specific roles or clearance levels that mandate physical presence, and is there flexibility for reach-back support from other cleared facilities?	IDCS work performance is primarily in San Antonio, TX. Vendors should plan their staffing for ~>75% of Task Order execution to be performed in San Antonio, TX. KPPs are required to be in San Antonio, TX for the duration of their awarded task (more details will be in RFP).
37	RFI 2 Letter	2	Small Business Set Aside	Will SPARTAN use small-business set-aside pools and/or socio-economic tracks? How many awards are envisioned, with what ordering period, ceiling, and minimum guarantee per awardee?	The Government is considering small and large business pools for SPARTAN however the market research results will determine the selected course of action.
38	RFI 2 Letter	2	On-Off Ramp IDIQ Vendors	How will on-/off-ramping work over the life of the MAC IDIQ, and will there be pool competitions at the Task Order level or best-fit directed awards?	The Government is currently exploring various on-/off-ramping strategies and task order award approaches, including potential pool competitions and best-fit directed awards, with all decisions remaining pre-decisional pending further market research.
39	SOO	4.1	Artifacts	Which acquisition artifacts will be tailored under the Software Acquisition Pathway (e.g., what is required vs. waived)?	Tailored artifacts, and remaining artifacts (to be executed) will be determined and communicated at a later date.
40	RFI 2 Letter	2	Ordering Guide/ Sample TO Eval Criteria	Will the Government publish a draft Ordering Guide and sample Task Order evaluation criteria prior to solicitation?	The Government will inform potential offerors at a later date.
41	SOO/RFI 2 Letter	2.3/2	IS-ICD and RDP Documents	When will the IS-ICD and RDPs be released, and in what sequence (to support meaningful TO pricing/schedule)?	See SOO, Section 4.5

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42	SOO	<i>Appendix A</i>	Appendix A	Will the IDCS Capability Areas & Objectives Matrix (Appendix A) be shared in editable form to support traceability?	The editable IDCS Capability Areas & Objectives Matrix will be provided as part of the RFP.
43	SOO	4.5.4.2	Backlog	Who is the “delegated lower-level requirements authority” referenced for the dynamic backlog, and what is their cadence for prioritization?	The Chief Engineer is the requirements authority and the Technical Integration Lead Engineer is delegated authority to conduct the lower-level decomposition of requirements. When engineering solutions are ready for implementation, they are added to the backlog(s) of development teams based on a quarterly prioritization determined with inputs from lead command and stakeholders.
44	Whitepaper Template	<i>Technical & Security Capabilities</i>	CMMC Level 3	Please confirm whether CMMC Level 3 compliance is a formal requirement for offerors at the time of IDIQ award, or if this is requested only for informational purposes at the RFI stage.	This RFI is for market research, including gathering feedback on the application of CMMC Level 3 to all or some IDCS capabilities. Your input will help balance fair competition with appropriate compliance levels for critical aspects of the IDCS System of Systems.
45	Whitepaper Template	<i>Whitepaper Template – Technical & Security Capabilities</i>	CMMC Level 3	If required, will compliance be at the organizational level or flowed down to subcontractors as well?	CMMC requirements that are placed on prime contractors will flow down to subcontractors but the IDCS PMO is assessing the tailoring of flow-down CMMC requirements to the subcontractor. The tailoring determination will likely be made based on the Critical Defense Information (CDI) that will flow-down to the subcontractor --this will drive CMMC compliance requirements and Government approval/disapproval/s (DFAR 252.204-7012)

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46	Whitepaper Template	<i>Whitepaper Template – Technical & Security Capabilities</i>	CMMC Level 3	If not required at award, is CMMC Level 3 expected to be a future requirement for task order execution?	CMMC level 3 compliance as of the RFI is a market survey information request. CMMC strategy will be finalized at RFP.
47	Whitepaper Template	<i>Whitepaper Template – Technical & Security Capabilities</i>	CMMC Level 3	The RFI indicates the Government's intent to encourage broad participation, including from small businesses and socio-economic categories. We are concerned that making CMMC Level 3 compliance mandatory at base award would significantly restrict small business participation. Can the Government clarify whether it will provide a phase-in period, alternate compliance pathway, or risk-based approach to avoid unintentionally excluding small business vendors?	We will take the suggestion into consideration. More details on what the Government will accept for CMMC will be provided within the RFP
48	SOO	4.2	Government-as-Integrator & Teaming	With the Government serving as system integrator/product owner, what governance forums (e.g., PI planning, change control) will vendors participate in, and what are the decision rights?	Vendors will be informed of decisions made as part of the change management. Vendors will receive direction on planning priorities. The Government will seek vendor input to assist in decision making as needed.
49	RFI 2 Letter	3.4.1, Table 2	Associate Contractor Agreements	Please provide (or confirm) the list of associate/partner contractors we will be required to coordinate with via ACAs; is Table 2 the initial set?	No, ACA's have not been identified yet, because the IDIQ had not been awarded. This would occur after award. The vendors listed in Table 2, are names of vendors that are part of the Governments Non-Government Advisors.

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50	SOO	<i>4.2.1</i>	Associate Contractor Agreements	Will a Government-provided ACA template be issued, and can you clarify data-sharing expectations and conflict resolution under ACAs?	We will take the suggestion into consideration. All data that will be created under this contract will fall within the FAR clauses and will belong to the Government. The Government intends to share relevant data to other vendors when necessary to ensure what is being developed will operation with the IDCS system.
51	SOO	<i>4.3</i>	Operating Constraints Open Standards	Section 4.3 prohibits “proprietary formats” yet allows limited proprietary technologies with justification—please define acceptable exceptions (e.g., cloud-native managed services) and the approval process.	HNCD Leadership is the approval authority for any deviations or implementations that will result in vendor proprietary tools, software, interfaces, protocols, schemas, formats, extensions, encryption, encoding, or services.
52	SOO	<i>4.3</i>	Operating Constraints Open Standards	What specific data models, schemas, and interface standards will be mandated up-front vs. defined per TO?	The IDCS PMO is not sharing this data at this time. There are considerations for facilitating a 'data-share' reading room, vendor one-on-ones, or sharing requested data through future solicitations.

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53	SOO	4.4	Cloud Environments Technical Expertise	Which target environments are in scope at program start (Cloud One, Platform One, JWCC, others), at which classification levels, and what CDS approach is expected?	4.4 requirements are beyond just hosting environments within cloud CSPs. All environments are within scope as well as others. All classifications are within scope moving data up through the CDS. CDS will be defined by the Government at time of award of future task orders. More details will be provided as part of the RFP with the addition of a potential CUI level reading room. It will require DoD CAC/ECA and DoD email to access it. Instructions will be provided as part of the RFP package. Detailed requirements will be provided for Task Orders with any applicable/ supporting core documentation.
54	SOO	4.4	Cloud Environments Technical Expertise	Will Government provide landing zones and ATO baselines in each enclave, or is the contractor responsible for establishing them?	The Government seeks for the vendor to provide this effort as defined by enclave or hosting CSP.
55	SOO	4.5.1.3	Performance Standards 99.9% Uptime	CA-1 specifies 99.9% infrastructure uptime; are there RTO/RPO, latency, and backlog burn-down targets to accompany uptime?	System performance is specified via the IS-ICD.

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56	SOO	4.5.2.3	Performance Standards quality levels of DevSecOps	CA-2 lists DevSecOps metrics, but minimum standards are “to be identified in TOs.” Can you publish baseline thresholds/targets for MTDD/MTTR/deploy frequency now to guide solutions?	While specific minimum thresholds for DevSecOps metrics like MTDD, MTTR, and deployment frequency will be defined at the task order level to account for varying system complexities and operational contexts, the Government anticipates baseline targets generally aligned with industry best practices for continuous improvement and rapid incident response, as reflected in the DoD Enterprise DevSecOps Reference Design and Strategy Guide.
57	SOO	4.5.2	Performance Standards & Metrics	Will there be a standardized QASP and code quality “Assessment Matrix” shared pre-solicitation for estimating compliance effort?	Yes, a QASP will be included/required for all Task Order's, and assessment matrices will be shared with applicable Task Orders.
58	SOO	8.4	Data Rights	The SOO states the Government will acquire “unlimited rights” to all technical data and computer software developed for IDCS. Please confirm treatment of: (a) pre-existing IP/background components, (b) commercial licenses, and (c) OSS with reciprocal licenses.	The intent of is statement is in reference to GOTs, and highly modified and secured FOSS that is within the scope of the license agreement/published. Anything that is solely developed under this contract shall be unlimited rights to the Government IAW DFAR clauses 252.227-7013, 252.227-7014, 252.227-7018 and 252.227-7025.

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59	SOO	<i>5.1, CDRLs</i>	CDRL	Several CDRLs imply delivery of SBOMs and source code; which artifacts are mandatory for all TOs vs. “as needed,” and what repositories (e.g., Iron Bank/DoD repo) must we use?	In alignment with EO 14028 and cybersecurity maintenance needs, the Government anticipates requiring SBOMs (in machine-readable format) for software deliverables, with specific artifact requirements detailed in Task Order solicitations; furthermore, source code access will be necessary for cybersecurity code analysis, and the Government expects utilization of DoD repositories and/or Iron Bank, reserving the right to leverage any Government resource to support program objectives, unless otherwise directed.
60	SOO	<i>5.1, CDRLs</i>	CDRL	Will the “Data Rights Assertion List” be required at IDIQ level or per TO, and what assertion format is expected?	The Government reserves the rights to request a Data Rights Assertion List.
61	SOO	<i>3.3</i>	Clearance	Is an active TS/SCI FCL required at base award, or will the Government accept proof of sponsorship/in-process?	See Amend 1, Attachment 1_SPARTAN SOO_Rev 16 Sept 2025, Section 7.1 The requirement will consist of scope ranging from Unclassified up to including Top Secret/SCI, the government seeks a qualified vendor pool for entire scope and will not accept any “in-process” TS/SCI FCLs, the government does encourage teaming and/or partnering with current TS/SCI FCLs companies.

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62	SOO	3.3	Clearance	The SOO requires 20% of staff “actively cleared upon award,” plus cleared KPPs, with potential polygraphs. Please define: (a) which LCATs count toward the 20%, (b) timing for meeting the percentage, and (c) when/whether polygraphs will be imposed.	See Amend 1, Attachment 1_SPARTAN SOO_Rev 16 Sept 2025, Section 7.1.1.1 was removed.
63	SOO	3.3	JIRA/Confluence Access	All positions require CAC/ECA access to Jira/Confluence—will accounts/environments be Government-provisioned, and what lead times should we plan?	Accounts and CaC access will be provisioned by the Government upon new awards. The lead time for getting into JIRA once a person has a CaC should be 1-3 days depending on volume of requests. The duration of time it takes to get a CaC could vary based on if a the have a Clearance or has been vetted in the past.
64	SOO	5.1	Place of Performance	KPPs must be local to San Antonio or commute 4–5 days/week. How many KPPs (by role) are anticipated, and are hybrid/remote exceptions possible for non-KPP staff?	Government is still evaluating the percentage threshold for KPPs and all cleared personnel, and will be further defined at RFP.
65	SOO	5.2	Hours/Duty Days	Normal duty hours are specified; is any 24x7/after-hours support required for incident response, and how will surge be handled?	Some CAs may require 24/7 normal duty hours that will be decided at the task order level. Government is still evaluating methods in which surge will be utilized and will be further defined at RFP.

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66	LCAT Table	<i>LCAT Table</i>	LCAT	The LCAT workbook (Attachment 2) guides skill levels. Will the Government publish mandatory certs per LCAT (e.g., DoDI 8140 mappings) and identify any missing roles they want industry to propose?	Yes however, they are subject to change as new certifications become an industry standard and IAW with DoD policy and to meet the requirements associated with a Task Order
67	SOO	5.2	Hours/Duty Days	Please confirm whether remote work is authorized outside San Antonio for non-KPP roles across all TOs.	Remote work for certain positions may be authorized based on the requirements associated with that TO. If remote work is approved, Travel to San Antonio for tasks required to perform will be at the cost of the Vendor.
68	SOO	3.5	Focal Point	The Focal Point must respond within 12 business hours; what constitutes “urgent” communications, and are there SLA penalties?	12-business hours is a reasonable amount of time to respond to initiated communication. SLA penalties will be dictated as part of a SLA/Task Order.
69	SOO	3.5	N/A	What is the expected cadence/format for MSRs, PI planning, and quarterly reviews across vendors?	Cadence/Format will be determined at RFP and could be modified based off task order requirements.
70	SOO	10.3	RACIQ Template	Will the Government provide a standard RACIQ template and define approval criteria ahead of proposal?	Yes. The intent is to ensure there is a standardized effort that identifies key shareholders and stakeholders across the entire IDCS effort.

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71	SOO	7.4.1	Testing	Will Government furnish an ATO “inheritance” package and approved control baselines, or are contractors expected to generate full RMF packages per component?	In accordance with Cyber Security implementation, as outlined in DoDI 8500.01, the Government intends to provide an ATO inheritance package, including approved control baselines aligned with NIST SP 800-53, to facilitate efficient RMF compliance; however, contractors will be responsible for tailoring and supplementing the package to address component-specific controls and unique system characteristics, ensuring comprehensive security and alignment with the overall IDCS security architecture, as per the risk management framework.
72	SOO	4.5.8	Testing	Which Zero Trust and Cyber Survivability Attribute artifacts are required at baseline vs. per TO (e.g., A090 ZTA Implementation Report; CSA Compliance Assessment)?	The Government is evaluating the allocation of ZTA/CSA artifact requirements, expecting a high-level ZTA Implementation Report (A090) and CSA Compliance Assessment (A091) at the IDIQ level to demonstrate initial compliance; specific artifacts will then be tailored and required at the Task Order level based on system/mission needs (SOO 7.4.1, 7.4.2), with RMF security packages (A070) & compliance with enterprise ZT policy developed per Task Order and details to follow as CMMC evolves.
73	SOO	4.5.8	Testing	Are Certificate-to-Field (CtF) requirements and Iron Bank hardening mandatory for all software deliveries?	Yes.

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74	SOO	11, Table 1	CDRL	Table 1 is labeled “Example CDRLs” while also reserving the right to add more. Which CDRLs are baseline across the IDIQ vs. TO-specific?	At this time there are no CDRLs that will be required as part of the IDIQ. CDRLs will be identified at the TO for what is required as part of that scope.
75	SOO	5.1, DFARS 25	CDRL	For cost/schedule data (CSDR, SRDR/FlexFile, Quantity Data), will these apply to FFP TOs, and what thresholds trigger them?	For CSDR, SRDR/FlexFile, and Quantity Data reporting—are potentially applicable even to FFP Task Orders—determinations will be Task Order-specific (DFARS 234.71, DoDI 5000.73) based on dollar value, complexity, and risk; thresholds, aligning with DoD CSDR policy, will be in Task Order solicitations, balancing Government visibility and contractor burden.
76	SOO	5.1, CDRLs	CDRL	Several security/DevSecOps deliverables are “Monthly or Quarterly (IAW TO).” Can the Government publish default frequencies now (e.g., VARs, container scans, IaC scans)?	Deliverables will vary based on TO.
77	SOO	3.4	Training	CA-9 requires a multi-tier service desk and training. What are target service levels (e.g., call answer times, first-contact resolution) and required training modalities (ILT, VILT, CBT)?	Specific target service levels (e.g., call answer times, first-contact resolution) and required training modalities (ILT, VILT, CBT) will be determined and defined at the task order

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78	General	3.4	Training	Are there Government-furnished training environments and representative datasets for courseware/testing?	The PMO is responsible for Type-1 training. Currently the PMO only provides 1 area for mission rehearsal for 1 weapon system. There are current datasets and courseware for the Type-1 training, however the predominance of these artifacts are for legacy systems.
79	SOO	5.4	Travel Forecasting	Please define anticipated CONUS/OCONUS travel volumes by role and typical trip duration for planning purposes.	While specific CONUS/OCONUS travel volumes and trip durations will be defined at the task order level. The Government anticipates travel requirements to vary based on role and task complexity/duration; Contractors shall propose travel volumes, durations, and types, with their SOO solutions and will also consider travel is pre-approved and required based on the mission need, while minimizing costs where possible.

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80	SOO	2.1.4	Cloud Services, Hybrid Architecture, and Scalability: Describe your experience designing and implementing cloud services and hybrid architectures that meet demanding performance and scalability requirements in DoD environments (similar to IDCS), especially with Cloud One and Platform One. Provide specific project examples where you achieved challenging performance targets, scaled to meet demands, and ensured efficient resource utilization. Include supporting metrics and data.	Can the Government provide a list of software and specific technologies that the contractor will be responsible for integrating?	More details will be provided as part of the RFP with the addition of a potential CUI level reading room. It will require DoD CAC/ECA and DoD email to access it. Instructions will be provided as part of the RFP package. Detailed requirements will be provided for Task Orders with any applicable/ supporting core documentation.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
81	SOO	2.8.1	Test and Evaluation Master Plan (TEMP) and Testing Methodologies:	Describe your approach to developing and implementing a Test and Evaluation Master Plan (TEMP), specifying the testing methodologies and tools you will utilize. What type of testing is currently in use for this requirement?	See Amend. 1, Attachment 1, SPARTAN SOO_Rev 16 Sept 2025, Section 4.5.8.2. changed from “Test and Evaluation Master Plan (TEMP)” to “Test and Evaluation Strategy (TES).” The PMO has an overarching Test and Evaluation Strategy (TES) that encompasses contractor, developmental, operational, automated software pipeline testing, and cyber testing. The results of testing are used to gain approvals through Air Force operational acceptance, certificates to field, ATO, and fielding authorization(s). IAW DODI 5000.87 DAFI 63-150, Air Force Supplemental to the Software Acquisition Pathway
82	RFI 2 Letter	2.8.2	Automated Testing for IDCS:	Describe specific automated testing tools and techniques you would use to improve test efficiency and coverage in IDCS. Does the Government currently have automation for functional testing user experience (UX) for this requirement. Has the Government already evaluated or is the Government already utilizing agentic testing?	No.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
83	RFI 2 Letter	2.8.2	Automated Testing for IDCS:	Describe specific automated testing tools and techniques you would use to improve test efficiency and coverage in IDCS. Has the Government already evaluated or is the Government already utilizing agentic testing?	No.
84	RFI 2 Letter	2.11.1.2	SPARTAN SOO Implementation Strategy:	Describe your overall implementation strategy for meeting the objectives outlined in the SPARTAN SOO. How will you prioritize tasks and manage dependencies between different CAs? Provide a detailed and realistic implementation plan, including key milestones, dependencies, and risk mitigation strategies, justifying your prioritization. Is there a list of existing programs or capabilities that currently provide the CAs that this solicitation anticipates incorporating in the initial period of performance?	The Government has not made a determination on CA structure but will inform potential vendors at a later date.
85	SOO RFI 2 Letter	4.5.1 2.1	Capability Area	Can you provide more details on the expected configuration and management of hybrid cloud infrastructure, especially in terms of security and resilience?	IL-5, IL-6, 99.9% availability in the cloud, all software is cloud native deployed in iron at each DAF base and in the GovCloud for C2 and management and central report.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
86	SOO	4.5.2	Capability Area	Can you provide more details on the expected integration of Hardware-in-the-Loop (HIL) simulation environments for software testing?	The software development and deployment model is in a CI/CD environment that requires for rapid test and deliver to hardware and cloud environments. The E2E testing requires HIL to ensure containers are ready for productions prior to releasing to endpoint server stacks.
87	SOO	4.5.5	Capability Area	What are the specific legacy DCO systems that need to be integrated with the IDCS, and what are the key challenges anticipated in this integration? Can the Government provide this information including IDCS architecture (e.g. DODAF views) and roadmap for planned modernization in a Bidder's Library?	More details will be provided as part of the RFP with the addition of a potential CUI level reading room. It will require DoD CAC/ECA and DoD email to access it. Instructions will be provided as part of the RFP package. Detailed requirements will be provided for Task Orders with any applicable/ supporting core documentation.
88	SOO	4.5.6	Capability Area	Can you provide more details on the expected communication capabilities for DCO forces operating in DDIL conditions?	Communication capabilities will be aligned with a regional SOC concept with limited, degraded, or no connectivity off of the local base which includes future capabilities provided by the SDWAN provided by forthcoming Air Force infrastructure device modernization efforts focused on allowing bases to operate in a disconnected state.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
89	SOO	4.5.9	Capability Area	What are the expectations for ongoing support and maintenance of the IDCS? Are there any specific service level agreements (SLAs) or support processes that need to be established? Would the service desk be required during core duty hours only or 24/7/365? What geography (e.g. CONUS) does the service desk cover?	Cannot discuss or go into this subject at an unclassified open forum.
90	SOO	4.5.9	Capability Area	What Service Desk and Service Management tools are deployed?	PMO/Operations Service Now, and Legacy Operations BMC Remedy.
91	SOO	4.5.3	Capability Area	Are the current IDCS components under approved ATO/s? If so, is the ATO/s set to expire within 6 months of the anticipated award?	Yes and Yes
92	SOO	4.5.4	Capability Area	Are the data sources referred to in the question related to internal or external sourcing? Is there an IDCS data architecture that can be shared via a Bidder's Library?	Yes, the sources sought are internal to the platform, system generated such as telemetry, and external data such as logs, alert, metadata. More details will be provided as part of the RFP with the addition of a potential CUI level reading room. It will require DoD CAC/ECA and DoD email to access it. Instructions will be provided as part of the RFP package. Detailed requirements will be provided for Task Orders with any applicable/ supporting core documentation.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
93	SOO	4.5.4	Capability Area	What existing cybersecurity platforms, SIEMs (Security Information & Event Management), SOARs (Security Orchestration, Automation & Response) or EDRs (Endpoint Detection & Response) are deployed today? Will data management/analytics require managing this data? Are there APIs or data to access this data?	DEVO SIEM SPLUNK SOAR Deploying Elastic SIEM Deploying XSOAR SOAR
94	SOO	4.5.4	Capability Area	Approximately how much raw security data (in GB/TB per day) is generated today, and what retention period is mandated?	More details will be provided as part of the RFP with the addition of a potential CUI level reading room. It will require DoD CAC/ECA and DoD email to access it. Instructions will be provided as part of the RFP package. Detailed requirements will be provided for Task Orders with any applicable/ supporting core documentation.
95	SOO	4.5.4	Capability Area	What security controls must be in place for any data science environment (e.g., encryption at rest/in transit, privileged access management, zero-trust networking)?	There will be a dedicated data science zone within the Systems Integration Lab (SIL) with the appropriate ATO and security controls. Also the Big Data Platform (BDP) is a data LakeHouse enabling Data science and data warehouse. Security controls are enable.
96	SOO	4.5.4	Capability Area	What security level classification is the data (ex. IL4)?	At the level of the operational network hosting IDCS.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
97	SOO	4.5.4	Capability Area	What are the expectations for ongoing support and maintenance of the IDCS? Are there any specific service level agreements (SLAs) or support processes that need to be established?	Generally the PMO supports tier 2 and tier 3 maintenance and SLAs support the base and operator level maintenance necessary for a global distribution of hardware.
98	SOO	4.5.4	Capability Area	Is there an IDCS architecture and governance board to ensure that the IDCS function aligns with mission goals, manages risks, and delivers value efficiently while establishing control, promote consistency, seamless interoperability, and prevent technical and data sprawl, especially given enterprise-wide impact.	Yes there is an IDCS architecture governance board.
99	SOO	4.5.6	Capability Area	What is the technology stack of the existing program focuses on protecting DoD networks from cyber threats?	More details will be provided as part of the RFP with the addition of a potential CUI level reading room. It will require DoD CAC/ECA and DoD email to access it. Instructions will be provided as part of the RFP package. Detailed requirements will be provided for Task Orders with any applicable/ supporting core documentation.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
100	SOO	4.5.4	Capability Area	How many different mobile and sensor platforms need to be integrated? Does IDCS need to integrate with systems outside of United states? How many potential users for the IDCS platform? Are they all CAC users or are some non-CAC users?	More details will be provided as part of the RFP with the addition of a potential CUI level reading room. It will require DoD CAC/ECA and DoD email to access it. Instructions will be provided as part of the RFP package. Detailed requirements will be provided for Task Orders with any applicable/ supporting core documentation.
101	General	<i>General</i>	Industry Discussions	Will there be an Industry Day or one-on-one sessions before RFP release?	The Government has not made any final decisions on whether draft RFP will be done.
102	General	<i>General</i>	IDIQ Award	Will SPARTAN be competed as a single MAC IDIQ or will it be split into pools (e.g., large vs. small business, capability area pools)?	See RFI 2 Letter, Section 1.2 The Defensive Cyber Systems Branch (AFLCMC/HNCD) is considering standing up a SPARTAN Multi-Award Contract (MAC) Indefinite-Quantity Indefinite-Delivery (IDIQ) contract and is conducting market research to identify potential sources. The results will assist the Government in deciding small or other than small businesses in each capability area.
103	SOO	6.3	Key Personnel Positions (KPPs)	How many KPPs are required at RFP submission? Will Letters of Commitment be required with the proposal?	KPP levels and guidelines (i.e. LoCs) will be shared at time of RFP release.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
104	SOO	2	Scope	“As a System of Systems (SoS), a collection of independent systems that integrate to achieve a capability that none of the constituent systems could accomplish individually, the IDCS requires coordinated integration across multiple platforms, leveraging existing systems and incorporating new solutions with open standards and a hybrid cloud architecture.” Who is responsible for the RMF requirements, will it be the application owners or the successful contractor for this effort?	The awardee will be responsible under direction of the Government.
105	RFI 2 Letter	2.3.1	Zero Trust Architecture in a System of Systems (SoS) Environment	Can the Government provide high level Zero Trust Architecture requirements which must be met?	The Air Force has a ZT reference architecture and forthcoming ZT hardware, tools, and applications. IDCS must be interoperable and conformant to enterprise solutions for ZT which are not yet mature and are still traversing the acquisition and engineering process.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
106	Whitepaper Template	<i>I.D vi.</i>	Technical & Security Capability	Will a cleared facility be required to participate in the solicitation response or is a cleared facility required after award?	Vendors will be required to have at a minimum SIPR facility clearance upon award of the IDIQ. It is not the Governments intent or responsibility to sponsor, or provide necessary cryptologic equipment to support IDCS. The vendors will have access to Government owned approved Systems Integration Lab (as space is available) and task order specific development environments. If a vendor, does not have a facilities clearance, vendor must have the ability to operate within a cleared facility to preform work (and any associated agreements in place to prove facility access). Any subsequent task order(s) that require a facility clearance, vendors must have that clearance to preform those task orders upon award.
107	General	<i>General</i>	Evaluation	How will the Government evaluate innovation versus risk?	The Government will use a holistic evaluation process to assess vendor ability prior to IDIQ award and prior to task order award. Based on vendor approach and Government evaluation the most capable vendor will be selected for the specified work

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
108	General	<i>General</i>	Evaluation	Will evaluation favor breadth (all CAs) or depth (specialized capability)?	If a vendor does not have experience in a particular area, it is not the IDCS PMO's expectation for vendors to populate CAs where they have little/no relevant experience. It is recommended that vendors primarily choose the capability/capabilities (CAs) where they believe they are most capable.
109	RFI 2 Letter	3.2 & 3.3	Documentation Marking and Proprietary Information	The question regarding conflicts of interest and vendor relationships is in both Section 1 and Section 3 of the response template. Please confirm that a response in Section 3 (in addition to Section 1) is only required if the company's response is proprietary.	See Amend. 1, RFI 2 Letter SPARTAN_Rev 16 Sept 2025, Section 3.3 has been updated to Use of Non-Governmental Advisors. Proprietary Information and Vendor relationships are two different things. Proprietary information is information proprietary to a company, and a vendor might only want to share with Government employees. Vendor relationships, and in Section 3.3 Use of non-Government Advisors, is to inform potential offerors that the Government has non-Governmental advisory and assistance contractors that are working this effort. If there are any potential conflicts with the vendors in Table 2, and the potential offeror, please identify in your response.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
110	General	<i>N/A</i>	IDIQ Award	How many IDIQ contract awardees are anticipated under the tentative multiple award contract construct? Additionally, will there be on-ramp opportunities at the IDIQ level during the MAC IDIQ period of performance?	The Government will inform potential offerors at a later date. Should it be in the Governments best interest, there will allow on-ramp opportunities at the IDIQ level during the MAC IDIQ period of performance?
111	General	<i>N/A</i>	Contract Type	What is the anticipated contract type at the order level, such as Firm Fixed Price, Time & Materials / Labor Hour, or Cost Reimbursable? Will cost-type contracts be limited to specific Capability Areas?	The Government has not made any final decisions on contract type, however it is possible that the Government will consider multiple contract types on the IDIQ in order to support the effort outlined in Attachment 1 SPARTAN SOO, Section 2. SCOPE.
112	Whitepaper Template	<i>D.x.</i>	Contract Type	Where in the response template should vendors provide feedback or recommendations on contract types for IDIQ orders?	See Amend. 1. Attachment 3. Rev. SPARTAN Whitepaper Template, Section D.x. added a question, "What contract type/s is/are appropriate for this effort?"
113	RFI 2 Letter	<i>I.I</i>	Joint ventures or teaming arrangements	Joint ventures or teaming arrangements are also encouraged. If you propose a teaming arrangement, please clearly identify the roles and responsibilities of each team member in your response. Can companies expect feedback in the way of suggested teamings based on RFI responses?	It's possible, however without know what the responses will be, it's difficult to make that determination at this time.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
114	RFI 2 Letter	<i>2.1.1</i>	Integrating Cloud One and Platform One	Detail your experience integrating Cloud One and Platform One, providing specific examples of successful implementation. In this context, is “Platform One” referring to P1 Big Bang, P1 Party Bus, P1 Iron Bank, all of these, or something else? If P1 Big Bang is implied, could a Big Bang conformant stack be considered as an acceptable substitute?	Yes to all of the P1 aspects when it comes to experience. The PMO is not looking to fundamentally change the stack to any substitute of what we have now.
115	RFI 2 Letter	<i>2.1.3</i>	Prevent outages and ensure operational continuity	Describe proactive measures to prevent outages and ensure operational continuity. Is there tolerance for scheduled downtime for maintenance?	Yes, we are required to adhere to the Air Force ASI process for scheduled downtime and maintenance.
116	RFI 2 Letter	<i>2.1.3</i>	Prevent outages and ensure operational continuity	Describe proactive measures to prevent outages and ensure operational continuity. What is the target SLA for uptime required? (This informs the architecture and cost, if, for example, the target SLA uptime is 99.999%.)	SLA is dependent on a variety of parameters, however, it is expected these requirements will vary and is dependent at the Task Order level.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
117	RFI 2 Letter	2.2.3	Full SAFe implementation	Describe the criteria for determining when a full SAFe implementation is needed versus a lighter-weight approach. Is SAFe strictly adhered to today? What aspects of SAFe (or the current operating methodology) have been beneficial as well as detrimental?	SAFe is not the current or preferred methodology.
118	RFI 2 Letter	2.3.3	Continuous Security Monitoring, Intrusion Detection, and Incident Response	What is the existing team or service that ingests, manages, and responds to incidents in the current state?	We have a management stack that is used to monitor and respond to hardware and software issues, the end user of the system is ultimately responsible for monitoring all enterprise assets.
119	RFI 2 Letter	2.3.3	Continuous Security Monitoring, Intrusion Detection, and Incident Response	Is the requirement to collaborate and integrate with this existing setup or is the requirement to build and manage this capability?	Either approach would be acceptable.
120	RFI 2 Letter	2.3.4	Identifying, assessing, and mitigating supply chain risks	Describe your approach to identifying, assessing, and mitigating supply chain risks. Is the scope of this requirement strictly for software supply chain security or is it broader, including things such as the hardware supply chain?	Hardware and software.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
121	RFI 2 Letter	2.5.3	How will you ensure interoperability with DCO legacy systems?	Could you clarify if the “legacy systems” have existing interfaces that can be leveraged for integration (ex: APIs) or is there an existing Enterprise Service Bus that could be utilized?	While the Government is accessing and integrating legacy systems it will integrate those through enterprise services via Attachment 1, in the SPARTAN SOO, or API methods. The Government is looking for offerors to describe in their submittal on ways to leverage and expand the system with these approaches in mind. We plan to integrate as seamless as the legacy system allows with cyber domain and IT/Data infrastructure. More details on legacy systems interfaces will potentially be shared in future solicitations.
122	RFI 2 Letter	2.5.3	How will you ensure interoperability with DCO legacy systems?	Is there openness to migrating or replacing these legacy systems (in the medium to long term)?	The current PMO strategy is to integrate all of the legacy systems into the IDCS architecture.
123	RFI 2 Letter	2.9.1	Establishing and operating a multi-tiered service desk/help desk.	Explain your approach to establishing and operating a multi-tiered service desk/help desk. Is the preference to train an existing pool of help desk operators or is there an expectation that these resources do not exist today and would need to be provided?	There is an existing contract with personnel but the expectation is that these resources will need to be provided by the awardee.
124	SOO	3.7	To employ an agile development process and a Continuous Integration/Continuous Delivery (CI/CD) pipeline	Is it safe to assume that development would be completely low-side or would there be any need for high-side development?	IDCS work is performed on NIPR, SIPR and JWICS.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
125	SOO	<i>4.5.1.1</i>	This capability encompasses the design, implementation, security, management, and sustainment of all underlying cloud and on-premises infrastructure.	Is there an existing footprint of on-premise infrastructure that would be leveraged, or should a proposal include specific offerings (ex: a hyperconverged stack)?	There is an existing hyperconverged stack in both static and mobile configurations.
126	SOO	<i>4.5.1.1</i>	This capability encompasses the design, implementation, security, management, and sustainment of all underlying cloud and on-premises infrastructure.	- Is there an existing set of cloud accounts/subscriptions or is there a desire to build new cloud environments?	There are existing cloud accounts and there is a need to build new cloud environments.
127	SOO	<i>4.5.1.1</i>	This capability encompasses the design, implementation, security, management, and sustainment of all underlying cloud and on-premises infrastructure.	- If expected to build new for on-prem or cloud, would it be completely greenfield or is there a requirement to perform a migration/cutover?	There will be a combination of all cases mentioned.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
128	SOO	4.5.3.2	Achieve and maintain Authority to Operate (ATO) for all IDCS components	What personnel can be assumed to be provided to the team from the Government (ex: ISSMs, or ISSOs)?	A Government ISSM will be present within the PMO staff.
129	SOO	4.5.3.2	Achieve and maintain Authority to Operate (ATO) for all IDCS components	- Is there an estimated timeline as to when the need is for the initial ATO?	If there is not a current ATO at time of award, time objective is 90 days. The expectation is that there will be an existing ATO and the awardee will take over the management and sustainment of the ATO(s).
130	SOO	4.5.6.2	Contractor shall develop, assist with integration, and sustain C2 applications.	- Is there existing C2 applications that are desired to be leveraged or is the request to build net new C2 applications?	While the Government is determining plans, in alignment with section 2.1.1, the request for C2 application integration, sustainment, and development as seen in section 4.5.6.2, from the SPARTAN SOO. (Attachment 1) is to look to have a path to leverage, modernize, integrate or build from existing systems or look for a net new. As the program moves forward this will be determined.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
131	SOO	4.5.7.2	Ensure IDCS architecture and requirements (as identified by the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) publications, best practices, DoD/DISA policies/directives, and the Government policy letters) align with broader DoD and DAF enterprise architecture.	If publicly available, could these specific policies be named with links provided or referenced and attached to the SOO	While a comprehensive list of specific policies is not available at this time, the Government refers vendors to SPARTAN Appendix C.
132	SOO	4.5.10.2	Contractor shall provide comprehensive program and project management.	If the Government will serve to act as the Systems Integrator and product owner (per the SOO Section 2 Scope), can there be some delineation provided in terms of scope for the Program Management office roles and responsibilities?	While the Government IDCS PMO will oversee internal program management who will work cross-functionally with Government finance, contracting, engineering, etc., Task Orders will require contractor-provided Technical Program Managers or Program Managers; contractors should clearly delineate their program management approach within this structure, focusing on task execution, cost, schedule, and performance reporting to the Government IDCS PMO.
133	SOO	4.5.10.3	They shall possess required certifications and experience.	Are there specific certifications that could be listed for this requirement?	LCATs for engineers or engineering will require degrees that align to the requirements for the 08XX and 1550 Government job series.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
134	RFI 2 Letter	3.2	RFI Letter Section 3.2 and the mandatory response template - offerors are instructed to segregate all proprietary information into a separate Section 3 (“Proprietary Information”) of the response template, while also responding to all technical capability questions in Section 2, each with strict page limits.	This creates a practical conflict: - If all proprietary information is removed from Section 2, then the technical responses may lack critical details needed to properly address the Government’s questions. - Separating proprietary information into Section 3 also creates ambiguity around how page limits for each Section 2 capability response should be calculated, since a significant amount of the response content will necessarily spill into Section 3.	The Government is not allowing additional pages for proprietary information and any proprietary information should be included as part of the page count corresponding with that section.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
135	RFI 2 Letter	3.2	RFI Letter Section 3.2 and the mandatory response template - offerors are instructed to segregate all proprietary information into a separate Section 3 ("Proprietary Information") of the response template, while also responding to all technical capability questions in Section 2, each with strict page limits.	Please clarify whether: -Proprietary information must be entirely excluded from Section 2 responses, or whether it may be included within Section 2 as long as it is clearly marked? -If segregation into Section 3 is required, how page limits should be applied; will the proprietary appendix be excluded from page counts? As an alternative, would the Government consider allowing offerors to provide full, marked responses in Section 2 (including proprietary information), and if desired, provide a non-proprietary executive summary or sanitized version for broader Government use in Section 3?	The Government is not allowing additional pages for proprietary information and any proprietary information should be included as part of the page count corresponding with that section.
136	General	<i>General</i>		Understanding there is a SCIF requirement, can some of the scope of work be performed at an UNCLASSIFIED location?	Unclassified work may be approved, however, NIST 800-171 policy will be required for any Unclassified work (handling of Controlled Defense Information), that is outside of a Government location to ensure proper data protections.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
137	SOO	2	Capability Area	Are contractors expected to support all 10 CAs under the base award, or will CAs be divided across TOs by specialty or by large and small business? (If divided, please share anticipated groupings.)	No contractors will not be expected to perform across all CAs. Each CA will have its own set of Task Orders to compete/award. It is encouraged for small/large businesses to identify your company's strengths in one or more of IDCS' CAs and solely compete and/or team to increase chances of selection/award in any of the 10 IDCS CAs.
138	RFI 2 Letter	1.2	IDIQ Award	Has the Government determined the vendor vetting process and contract award criteria? If so, could the Government provide the details of that in advance of the solicitation release?	The Government will inform potential offerors at a later date.
139	RFI 2 Letter	3.3	Use of Non-Government Advisors	Will SETA (Systems Engineering and Technical Assistance) and A&AS (Advisory and Assistance Services) support contractors assisting IDCS efforts be permitted to bid on the SPARTAN MAC IDIQ?	See RFI 2 Letter, Table 2. AFLCMC (IDCS) Support Vendors. They would be A&AS Support contractors.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
140	SOO		SCIF	Given the limited availability of contractor-owned accredited SCIF suites in San Antonio, please advise whether the Government has pre-established, Government-sponsored connectivity (JWICS/SIPRNet/NIPRNet or mission-specific) at particular facilities or with designated providers. If not, will a leased commercial SCIF be acceptable, and will the Government sponsor accreditation (ICD-705/AO) and furnish required circuits/COMSEC? Please also note any preferred locations or constraints that would affect site selection and schedule.	A leased facility will be acceptable if it is operational and connected at the time of award.
141	General	<i>General</i>	Contract Type	Has the Government finalized the	The Government will inform potential offerors at a later date.
142	General	<i>General</i>	Contract Type	Will future task orders offer flexibility to include both FFP and CPFF contract types?	The Government has not made any final decisions on contract type
143	General	<i>General</i>	Incumbent Contractor	Can you identify the current incumbent contractor performing the work?	The Government can not identify this at this time.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
144	RFI 2 Letter	<i>2.11.3 2.11.3.1 and 2.11.3.2</i>	Additional Beneficial Questions	Throughout the balance of the RFI letter, the Government is seeking strategies or approaches. However, 2.11.3.1 and 2.11.3.2 ask for proposed solutions. Is the Government asking for a final proposed solution for these two questions?	Negative, the Government is seeking additional information on vendor approaches to implementing technologies and processes. This is to gain a better understanding of what capabilities and strategies may be applied to IDCS in the future.
145	RFI 2 Letter	<i>General</i>	Expected Task Orders	Will the Government provide a list of expected task orders and their timelines?	Any expected timelines (to include RFP, award, etc.) can not be determined at this time.
146	RFI 2 Letter	<i>General</i>	Task Orders	Will IDCS (as currently contracted) be a single task order under SPARTAN? What is the timeline for this task order? Will it be bid and awarded with the IDIQ?	The Government is reviewing current contracts that are being executed to identify when/if it is in the best interest of the Government to have that scope of work to move to the IDIQ
147	RFI 2 Letter	<i>General</i>	IDIQ Award	What is the anticipated minimum award for IDIQ awardees?	At this time the Government is not anticipating a minimum award for IDIQ awardees.
148	RFI 2 Letter	<i>General</i>	Task Orders	Will the Government fund IDIQ Program Management through a dedicated task order?	The Government is still evaluating this aspect of program management and association to a specific task order, more details will be released at RFP.
149	RFI 2 Letter	<i>General</i>	IDIQ Award	What is the anticipated contract ceiling of the IDIQ?	Any information regarding the award can not be determined at this time.
150	RFI 2 Letter	<i>General</i>	Budget	Can the Government provide any information on the associated budget program elements aligned to IDCS and the SPARTAN IDIQ?	No, not at this time.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
151	RFI 2 Letter	<i>General</i>	Budget	Can the Government provide any information on the annual funding profile for IDCS efforts over the duration of the vehicle?	No, not at this time.
152	RFI 2 Letter	<i>General</i>	OTAs	Based on recent Executive Orders, does the Government anticipate competing this IDIQ and/or Task Orders as OTAs?	No, not at this time.
153	RFI 2 Letter	<i>General</i>	Contract Type	What types of contracts (FFP, CPFF/IF/AF, T&M, etc.) does the Government envision being used for subsequent task orders?	We are considering all options at this time.
154	RFI 2 Letter	<i>General</i>	IDIQ Award	Post IDIQ award, how does the Government envision communication of the schedule of future task orders opportunities, with awardees? Are there any envisioned recurring engagements with IDIQ awardees outside of task order performance?	No. Future task orders will be advertised to IDIQ awardees.
155	RFI 2 Letter	<i>General</i>	Task Order notification and classification	What distribution mechanism does the Government envision using for IDIQ task order RFIs, RFPs, and other solicitations? And, does the Government envision the issuance of classified task order solicitations? If so, at what classification level?	Awardees of the IDIQ will be notified of future task orders(RFIs/RFPs) via email or distro box.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
156	RFI 2 Letter	<i>General</i>	SCIF	Given the Government's focus on San Antonio based support and the security requirements associated with SPARTAN, will the Government expect awardees to have existing San Antonio-based TS/SCI/SAP facilities in place at time of award of the IDIQ?	Specific Key personnel may be based on IDIQ/Task order award specified to be collocated in San Antonio alongside the program office. The Government is advising that vendors may be required to support that requirement of collocation of duties with the PMO.
157	RFI 2 Letter	<i>General</i>	Classified network access	Will the Government require JWICS or other classified network connectivity at time of award of the IDIQ? If not, will this be a requirement for subsequent task orders?	Vendors will be required to have at a minimum SIPR facility clearance upon award of the IDIQ. It is not the Governments intent or responsibility to sponsor, or provide necessary cryptologic equipment to support IDCS. The vendors will have access to Government owned approved Systems Integration Lab (as space is available) and task order specific development environments. If a vendor, does not have a facilities clearance, vendor must have the ability to operate within a cleared facility to preform work (and any associated agreements in place to prove facility access). Any subsequent task order(s) that require a facility clearance, vendors must have that clearance to preform those task orders upon award.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
158	General	<i>General</i>	Roadmaps of current weapon systems	Will the Government provide a Bidder's Library of relevant materials associated with the As-Is state and current To-Be roadmaps for each of the "existing Air Force cyber weapon systems that perform defensive cyberspace operations" which will become or are already part of the IDCS or the associated Sensor Platform?	A Bidder's Library/Libraries are being considered but will require appropriate verifications and access prior to being provided such as As-Is and To-Be artifacts. If libraries become an option, and access is provided to authorized to offerors, a link to these library repositories will be provided. To access it will require DoD CAC/ECA and DoD email to access it. Instructions will be provided as part of the RFP package. Detailed requirements will be provided for Task Orders with any applicable/ supporting core documentation.
159	SOO	4	Performance Standards	Section 4 Performance Requirements states that "TOs will include Performance Standards, Acceptance Criteria, and Surveillance Methods for assessing execution." Can the Government provide likely Key Performance Parameters, Technical Performance Measures (TPMs), Service level Agreements (SLA), or other metrics or measures that are envisioned as being required across the IDCS architecture, other than the example provided in Section 4.5.1?	The RFP will likely provide overarching KPPs, etc., however these quantitative metrics will be at the Task Order level to ensure IDCS performance requirements are met.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
160	SOO	4.5.3	Capability Area	Recommend that the Government add to the Task Description of CA 3: Cybersecurity Operations and Compliance the need to create Technical Performance Measures (TPMs) based on the defined system Cyber Survivability Risk Category (CSRC) and applicable Cyber Survivability Attributes (CSAs).	The Government will take this into consideration.
161	SOO	4.5.3	Capability Area	CA 3: Cybersecurity Operations and Compliance indicates that IDCS will include capabilities to conduct "continuous security monitoring, intrusion detection, and threat hunting activities." What is the Government's anticipated alignment, collaboration, and/or coordination in the development process under SPARTAN and the work being performed on USAF programs like DCRIOS and the ongoing activities of USAF CPTs and MDTs?	Development process details may be shared in future solicitations.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
162	SOO	4.5.3	Capability Area	Does the conduct of Mission Based Cyber Risk Assessments (MBCRAs), Cyber Table Tops (CTTs), Mission-Based Risk Assessment Process for Cyber (MRAP-C), and other forms of cyber assessment for IDCS or related capabilities fall within the scope of CA 3: Cybersecurity Operations and Compliance or any other CA defined in the SPARTAN SOO?	Yes, those activities will be within scope of CA-3.
163	SOO	4.5.3	Capability Area	The ability to perform cyber Red Team testing against documented nation-state actor threat profiles will be critical to the performance of CA 3: Cybersecurity Operations and Compliance and success in other Capability Areas. How will the Government evaluate bidders on this capability?	The Government will analyze the content that is provided within the section. Information provided in respects to those activities will be taken into consideration.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
164	SOO	4.5.5	Capability Area	CA 5: System and Enterprise Integration Services describes a broad scope of integration across defense, weapon systems, and critical infrastructure. Will data flow integration into the DCO/Cybersecurity capabilities within USAF Weapon/Mission Systems be within this scope of this IDIQ? If so, how will the Government evaluate bidder capability in this area? If not, is the plan for incident escalation and response to continue to be a largely manual process for USAF Weapon/Mission Systems?	The Government is reviewing current support that are being executed to support the Weapon Systems to identify when/if it is in the best interest of the Government to have that scope of work to move to the IDIQ.
165	SOO	4.5.5	Capability Area	CA 5: System and Enterprise Integration Services describes a broad scope of integration across defense, weapon systems, and critical infrastructure. Does this include Defense Critical Assets (DCAs) and Task Critical Assets (TCAs) that are USAF owned/sustained?	More details of the scope of Integration will be provided within a CUI repo that will be available for the RFP. In response to the RFI focus on integration of components, various software titles to support a system of systems type platform
166	SOO	6.3	Key Personnel Positions (KPPs)	Can the Government clarify that designation of KPPs is at the task order level?	Yes, confirmed.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
167	SOO	<i>7.1</i>	Contractor Security/Clearance Compliance	Managing SCI billets is a challenge for all Government programs and Contractors, is 'TS/SCI-eligible' sufficient for meeting the 'TS/SCI' requirement for KPPs?	TS/SCI-Eligible (SSBI fully adjudicated) is acceptable.
168	SOO	<i>12, Appendix A. IDCS Capability Areas & Objectives Matrix</i>	Table: 1. Cloud Services and Infrastructure Management; Row 1.11	Can the Government clarify the usage of the acronym KPP in Row 1.11 of Appendix A?	Key Performance Parameter
169	SOO	<i>General</i>	Release of IDCS IS-ICD document	The Government indicates in numerous places within the SOO that the IDCS IS-ICD will be "released at a later date." Can the Government confirm that the IDCS IS-ICD will be provided to potential bidders at or before RFP issuance?	More details will be provided as part of the RFP with the addition of a potential CUI level reading room. It will require DoD CAC/ECA and DoD email to access it. Instructions will be provided as part of the RFP package. Detailed requirements will be provided for Task Orders with any applicable/ supporting core documentation.
170	SOO	<i>Appendix C. References; 12, Appendix A. IDCS Capability Areas & Objectives Matrix</i>	Table: 8. Test, Evaluation, and Validation Services; Row 8.1	The Government lists DoDI 5000.87, Operation of the Software Acquisition Pathway as a Reference and mentions the Software Acquisition Pathway under 8. Test, Evaluation, and Validation Services in Appendix A, row 8.1. Can the Government elaborate on how the Software Acquisition Pathway will be applied to the SPARTAN IDIQ or subsequent task orders?	During the intended release of the IDIQ we will be in the Execution phase of SW. Future releases and capabilities developed under the IDIQ will be associated with the iteration releases. Future vendors will be required to provide artifacts to support required reporting to inform leadership and stakeholders of the status of work

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
171	SOO	<i>Appendix C. References;</i>	CSEIG reference	The provided link for the CSEIG reference points to Version 2 rather than the more current Version 3 (released 12 Aug 2022). Does the provided link need to be updated or is the IDCS IS-ICD/IS-CDD tied to the older version for purposes of CSRC Tiering and CSA definitions?	We pulled down the guide from DAU. If there is more current guide please provide the URL and we will update it accordingly
172			CMMI-4 requirement	Given that the SPARTAN project's mission success depends on rapid response and agile development cycles, would the Government consider waving or modifying the CMMI-4 requirement to better align with the project's need for speed and adaptability?	No.
173			List of consolidated contracts that create IDCS	Would the Government list the current contract numbers and the current performers that are being combined into the SPARTAN contract?	The Government will inform potential offerors at a later date.
174			FTE	Would the Government give an initial FTE count	The Government will inform potential offerors at a later date.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
175	Whitepaper Template	<i>I</i>	Clarification of instructions	Attachment 3 specifies that respondents shall adhere to the standardized format in this file. However, the template contains instructions and other material that does not seem to belong in a response. Does the Government intend on respondents to include 1.a.i "Content and Structure: Your whitepaper must be structure into the following sections below"?	Since this is a "TEMPLATE" it is a guide to ensure contractors respond using the same format. The Instructions should not be included in the response. Contractors responses will start with Section 1.B. Vendor Information.
176	Whitepaper Template	<i>I</i>	Clarification of instructions	Is use of the company logo on the cover page acceptable, or must we spell out the Corporate name as listed in SAM?	Should be spelled out with company name as listed in SAM.gov.
177	Whitepaper Template	<i>I</i>	Clarification of instructions	Does the Government object to 1B and 1C being presented in a table format to make finding the responses simpler?	As long as the table can fit within the template structure/format
178	Whitepaper Template	<i>1.A.x</i>	Clarification of instructions	Will the Government accept tables that use 10-point Times New Roman?	Stay within the font format identified within the template

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
179	SOO	2	"The SPARTAN Multi-Award Contract (MAC) Indefinite-Quantity Indefinite-Delivery (IDIQ) will guide the acquisition, development, deployment, sustainment, and enhancement of IDCS capabilities."	How many vendors does the Government intend on awarding contracts to on the SPARTAN Multi-Award Contract (MAC) Indefinite-Quantity Indefinite-Delivery (IDIQ)?	The Government will inform potential offerors at a later date.
180	SOO	1	"Complementing the BDP is a caching Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) system for operational DCO analytics, alerting, and incident response, with global access for mission partners."	Regarding IDCS, which SIEM and SOAR are in scope?	Yes SIEM and SOAR are within the scope of IDCS, more details will be provided as part of the RFP with the addition of a potential CUI level reading room. It will require DoD CAC/ECA and DoD email to access it. Instructions will be provided as part of the RFP package. Detailed requirements will be provided for Task Orders with any applicable/ supporting core documentation.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
181	SOO	<i>1</i>	"The IDCS architecture further leverages a Sensor Platform, available in both fixed and mobile configurations for tactical detection, analysis, response, and transport."	Regarding IDCS architecture serving as a sensor platform for both fixed and mobile configurations, will the Government provide a list of the types and number of systems? This information enables contractors to appropriately size and fully scope their approach, providing end-to-end efficiencies to the Government.	More details will be provided as part of the RFP with the addition of a potential CUI level reading room. It will require DoD CAC/ECA and DoD email to access it. Instructions will be provided as part of the RFP package. Detailed requirements will be provided for Task Orders with any applicable/ supporting core documentation.
182	RFI 2 Letter	<i>2.5.1</i>	"System-of-Systems Integration (DoD Experience): Describe your experience with large-scale system-of-systems integration, specifically within a DoD environment."	In an effort to enhance competitive offers will the Government require vendors to offer DoD and commercial experience (per SecDef guidance) with similar size and scale to SPARTAN? The benefit to the Government is the ability to demonstrate DoD domain expertise and proven commercial expertise at scale with innovative capabilities resulting in increased productivity.	The Government is assessing evaluation criteria for the award of the Multi-Award IDCS . The Government will consider a strategy that meets the overall technical objectives and to demonstrate experience implementing DoD and commercial systems of similar size and scale to IDCS discusses innovation.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
183	RFI 2 Letter	2.10.3	Subcontractor Management and Governance: Provide concrete recommendations for improving the SPARTAN SOO's coverage of subcontractor management and governance processes, including specific contract clauses, oversight mechanisms, and performance metrics.	We recommend a solutions-based contract; and not a contract-based level of effort (LOE) approach. The solutions-based approach ties payment to outcomes and metrics versus dollars and hours. This approach provides the financial incentive to ensure all resources, prime and subcontractor, are focused on specific outcomes versus numbers of hours spent and ability to staff positions. The outcome-based contract includes small business goals and requires subcontract flowdowns, which are accompanied by a subcontract Statement of Work with metrics [tied to each area of the SOW that the subcontractor performs].	It is the intent of the Government to apply the best contracting strategy for each task order to match the scope of effort and the capacity of the PMO.
184			Clarification of instructions	Would it be possible for us to respond to only the areas we can add value, or provide a partial response?	Yes.
185			Clarification of instructions	Will your office provide a forum for possible teaming opportunities between vendors?	We are considering all options at this time to assist with vendor teaming.

Ques No.	Document / Attachment	Section / Paragraph #	In reference to:	Question/Comment	Government Response
186	LCAT Table	N/A	LCAT	We recommend an outcomes-based contract that requires the contractor to develop a basis of estimate (BOE) and not prescribe labor categories, hours, or levels of experience. We also recommend that the Government require the basis of estimate include supporting evidence of estimates provided. This outcomes-based approach allows the contractor to offer solutions with higher levels of automation; and thus, be more efficient than prescribed levels of effort. The solution-based contract will include metrics with contract penalties and incentives to each desired metrics versus a T&M labor-based effort focusing on labor expended which incentivizes billing to the maximum hours with maximum personnel.	The IDIQ will utilize a standard LCAT structure so the Government will have consistent baseline of capabilities that a FTE will be executing. Due to the name of an LCAT varying with no indication to what different capability one LCAT may have vs another. A common baseline will make resource management across multiple vendors more consistent.